

Final Reflection Essay Questions:

Name: William Gray

Major: Enterprise Technology Integration

Employer: Pennsylvania State University – Kaamran Raahemifar

Location: Remote

Internship Position: Short Squeeze Intern

The Internship

1. What were your goals for the internship? Were you successful in completing them? Why or why not?

My goal for this internship was to create a screener for predicting and identifying short squeeze candidates. I was successful in that goal as I successfully built a screener which identifies stock tickers that are likely to squeeze based on several live data metrics.

2. Identify challenges you faced in the experience and how you overcame them?

One of the big challenges that I faced was that I essentially spent half of the summer collecting data that was not of value to what my goal was. Essentially, I was collecting data on large cap stocks when I should have been collecting data on much smaller stocks as my goal was never to include these big-ticket stocks in my screener. I overcame this challenge by acknowledging my mistake, notifying my supervisor in a meeting that my error will set my project back, and then correcting my data collection to the correct data.

3. How did you contribute to the organization or your team through your internship?

I contributed my Screener. My goal was to create a Screener that can identify a squeeze and throughout my internship Everything I completed was a part of the process of completing my screener for short squeeze prediction. Further testing is required for my program but so far it has shown promise as a useful and profitable tool.

4. Were you able to see how networking supported the work that you or your colleagues worked on throughout your internship? Who were you able to add to your network? Have you taken a moment to thank them or share the news of completing your internship?

Networking was not a large part of my specific internship. I was the only one who worked on my screener program. Besides some advice from my supervisor, I completed this internship without any non-AI based assistance.

Professional Skills Development

5. At the beginning of your internship, you completed the Career Launch self-assessment. You were asked at that time to identify one professional skill that you were going to focus on developing through your experience. Please share what skill you decided to focus on and what your skill level was at the time of your first assessment. What steps did you take to grow and develop this skill, and did you accomplish any measurable improvement based on your re-assessment through Career Launch? Why do you think you did or did not develop or change this skill?

Career and Self-Development was the skill I wanted to focus on. When I first started that skill was identified as emerging knowledge but now it is listed as early application. While my internship itself may not have focused specifically on developing this skill, it allowed me to acquire new experience and gave me the confidence to talk to friends and family with careers in technology about my internship.

6. What other skills from the Career Launch survey did you become more aware of through your internship? How will you talk about using these skills in interviews and future career fairs/internship searches? (Be specific. Share an experience where you used a professional skill.)

I became more aware of my proficiency in technology as well as my communication skills. I had not realized how much I knew about working with technology until I was really tested in that aspect this summer. Additionally, while my communication skills aren't terrible, I have noticed that there is still room for improvement. I have noticed that sometimes I had an issue with responding to emails efficiently and would occasionally use confusing language. I hope moving forward I can further improve in that aspect.

7. How has this experience confirmed or changed your anticipated career path? Have you confirmed or changed the roles or industry that you had planned to pursue prior to the internship? Did you edit your career path after graduation? (Be sure to be specific. Tell us how it did or did not change.)

Originally going into this internship, I had hoped to find a job in software development, however now I have moved into wanting to work in an AI related field. I am going to further my knowledge of AI and how it can be used as to me the possibilities of AI seem endless right now. I have not edited any career paths as of yet but I plan on doing that sometime soon in the future.